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FREE RESOURCE

10 Ways to Love Your Brain

small daily habits for a clearer, calmer mind

Caregivers spend so much energy protecting everyone else's brain. Here's how to look after your own. *Memory tip:* Jennifer remembers these with the location & association technique. Picture each habit in a familiar spot, like the rooms of your home.

1. **Good brain diet.** Eat a balanced diet that's higher in vegetables to help reduce the risk of cognitive decline. And drink your **water**, because your brain needs to stay hydrated.
2. **Reduce negative thoughts (kill the ANTs).** Your mind is always eavesdropping on your self-talk, so keep it empowering and positive. ANTs are *automatic negative thoughts*.
3. **Exercise.** Regular movement that raises your heart rate increases blood flow to the brain and body. Several studies link physical activity with a reduced risk of cognitive decline.
4. **Brain nutrients.** If your busy life makes it hard to get everything from food, ask your doctor about essential brain nutrients like omega-3s and B vitamins.
5. **A positive peer group.** Buddy up. Staying socially engaged may support brain health. Spend time with people who inspire and challenge you. As they say, "if you're the smartest one in the room, you're in the wrong room!"
6. **Clean environment.** Take time to organize your surroundings, and stay away from hazards like smoke. Quitting smoking can bring your risk down to levels comparable with people who never smoked.
7. **Catch some Zzz's.** Not getting enough sleep can cause problems with memory, focus, and thinking.
8. **Brain protection.** Head injuries raise the risk of cognitive decline. Wear a seatbelt, and a helmet for contact sports or bike rides.
9. **New learning.** Hit the books, or take a class online. Keeping your brain active helps protect it.
10. **Stress management.** Anxiety puts you into fight-or-flight mode, which is not the ideal state for learning or remembering. Chronic stress is hard on your brain, so protect your calm.

THE SHORT LIST

Memorize these 10

1 Good brain diet · 2 Killing ANTs · 3 Exercise · 4 Brain nutrients · 5 Positive peer group · 6 Clean environment · 7 Sleep · 8 Brain protection · 9 New learning · 10 Stress management

JENNIFER'S 10-MINUTE RESCUE

Start ridiculously small

Pick **one** habit from this list and stack it onto something you already do, like ten deep breaths while the coffee brews. Tomorrow, do it again.



When the Blueprint Burned

The stories behind these tips, plus the full Unicorn Survival Toolkit, live in Jennifer's memoir. *Coming soon to Amazon*

Adapted with credit to Jim Kwik's brain-health habits. For general education and inspiration only. This is not medical advice. Talk with your healthcare provider about your own needs.